

DEVELOPMENT OF RADIO

Early transmitters could send out radio waves only in short bursts and used Morse code. For proper sound, continuous waves are needed. In 1906, Canadian-American engineer Reginald Fessenden invented an electric generator that could produce such waves. His first broadcast was on Christmas Eve, 1906. Regular broadcasting began in 1909, but it was not widely used until after World War I.



Crank handle is wound to generate electricity.

WIND-UP RADIO

In the early 1990s, English inventor Trevor Baylis designed a radio for use in remote places, where there was no electricity. It was powered by a clockwork motor that stored energy in a spring. Later radios, like this one, use energy from winding the handle to charge the battery.



A “crystal set,” the simplest type of radio receiver common in the early days of radio

▲ **CRYSTAL SET**
Household radios first became popular in the 1920s, when this radio was made.



DIGITAL RADIO

Digital broadcasting was first pioneered in the early 1980s, developed at the Institut für Rundfunktechnik in Munich, Germany. It was not popularly adopted until the early 2000s, but now broadcasters can offer more services and a higher-quality signal than ever before.